

Computing Professions and Laws:

1. The Framework of Employee Relations Law

2. Changing Management Practices

3. Human Resource Management and IT

4. Health and Safety at Work

The Framework of Employee Relations Law

Employee relations law governs the relationship between employers and employees. It includes all legal aspects that regulate employment terms, workers' rights, dispute resolution, contracts, and workplace behavior.

Laws and Regulations:

1) Industrial Relations Act (IRA 2012)

Governs the relationship between employers and employees in industries.

- **Allows** formation and registration of trade unions.
- **Provides** for Collective Bargaining Agents (CBA).
- **Establishes** Labour Courts and the NIRC for dispute resolution.
- **Regulates** strikes and lockouts with proper procedures.
- **Importance:** Ensures industrial peace, protects worker rights, and provides a legal platform for handling conflicts.

2) Employment Contracts Law

Covers legal employment agreements under the **Contract Act 1872** and **Shops and Establishments Ordinance**.

- Must include **job role, salary, working hours, benefits, and termination terms**.
- Contracts can be **fixed-term, indefinite, or probation-based**.
- Prevents disputes by ensuring written clarity.
- **Importance:** Provides mutual protection, clarifies obligations, and serves as legal proof.

3) Labour Protection Laws

Ensure safe and fair working conditions.

- **Minimum Wages Ordinance 1961:** Monthly wage limits set by provinces.
- **Working hours:** 8 hours/day, 48 hours/week (Factories Act).
- **Leaves:** Annual, sick, and casual leave granted by law.
- **Overtime compensation** is mandatory.
- **Importance:** Protects workers from exploitation and promotes work-life balance.

4) Anti-discrimination Laws

Ensure equality in the workplace.

- No discrimination in **hiring, promotion, pay, or termination** based on **gender, race, religion, disability**, etc.
- **Protection Against Harassment of Women at Workplace Act (2010)** ensures gender safety.
- Constitution's **Article 25** guarantees equality.
- **Importance:** Promotes fairness, diversity, and inclusion in organizations.

5) Termination and Redundancy Laws

Regulate lawful employee dismissal.

- **Termination without cause:** Requires 30-day notice or pay in lieu.
- **Termination with cause:** Must follow disciplinary procedures (e.g., show-cause notice).
- **Redundancy/Retrenchment:** Requires advance notice and compensation.
- **Compensation includes:** gratuity, provident fund, and leave encashment.
- **Importance:** Protects employees from arbitrary dismissal and ensures fairness.

6) Trade Union Rights

Employees have the right to form and join unions (min. 10 workers).

- Can **elect representatives** and act as a **Collective Bargaining Agent (CBA)**.
- Have legal rights to **strike** and **negotiate** under IRA 2012.
- **ILO Conventions 87 & 98** support these rights.
- **Importance:** Balances power between employers and workers, enabling collective voice and fair negotiations.

7) Social Security and EOBI (Employees' Old-Age Benefits Institution)

A. Social Security (Provincial)

- Provides **medical care, injury compensation, and disability benefits** under PESSI.

B. EOBI (Federal)

- Under the **EOBI Act 1976**, offers:
 - **Old-age pension**
 - **Invalidity pension**
 - **Survivors' pension**
 - **Old-age grant**
- Requires **15 years of contribution** and **retirement at age 60 (men), 55 (women)**.
- **Importance:** Ensures financial protection for employees after retirement or disability.

Final Summary Table:

Law/Act	Focus Area	Key Benefit
Industrial Relations Act	Unionization, dispute resolution	Protects collective rights
Employment Contracts Law	Appointment terms	Ensures clarity in job roles

Labour Protection Laws	Wages, hours, leave	Prevents worker exploitation
Anti-Discrimination Laws	Equality at work	Promotes fair and safe workplace
Termination & Redundancy Laws	Firing procedures	Ensures lawful dismissal
Trade Union Rights	Workers' representation	Enhances negotiation power
Social Security & EOBI	Post-retirement benefits	Supports employees in old age or injury

Importance:

- Protects both employers and employees.
- Maintains workplace harmony.
- Ensures fair treatment of workers.
- Reduces the risk of exploitation and conflicts.
- Provides guidelines for lawful hiring, firing, and management.

Aspects Covered:

- Employment contracts (appointment letter, salary, benefits)
- Employee rights and employer responsibilities
- Procedures for handling disputes and disciplinary actions
- Legal consequences for breaches of law



Changing Management Practices

Refers to the evolution and transformation of traditional management methods in response to technological advances, globalization, and workplace diversity.

Key Changes in Practice:

- **From Hierarchical to Flat Structures:** More autonomy at lower levels.
- **Remote/Hybrid Work:** Flexible schedules and work-from-home culture.
- **Use of Digital Tools:** Automation, cloud computing, AI in decision-making.
- **Emphasis on Innovation & Agility:** Companies must adapt quickly to change.
- **Focus on Employee Engagement & Inclusion:** Modern managers value collaboration, mental health, and inclusion.

Importance:

- Helps businesses stay competitive.
- Encourages innovation and creativity.
- Improves employee satisfaction and retention.
- Enables faster decision-making.

Aspects Covered:

- Leadership styles (transformational, servant leadership)
 - Agile and lean management techniques
 - Technological adaptation in managerial decisions
 - Training and development programs
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Human Resource Management and IT

HRM in IT refers to the process of recruiting, training, evaluating, and retaining employees in the technology sector. It also includes managing teams, technical roles, and adapting to the fast-changing IT industry.

Importance in IT Sector:

- IT professionals require continuous skill upgrades.
- HR must manage a highly competitive and dynamic talent pool.
- Ensures compliance with tech-industry-specific laws and ethics.
- Plays a crucial role in team performance and productivity.

Key Functions:

- **Recruitment & Onboarding:** Hiring skilled software engineers, developers, etc.
- **Training & Development:** Regular workshops on new technologies.
- **Performance Appraisal:** KPIs and project-based evaluations.
- **Employee Retention:** Benefits, work-life balance, career growth plans.
- **Compliance & Ethics:** Cybersecurity policies, intellectual property rights, data protection.

Types of HR Activities in IT:

- Technical hiring
 - Project-based team allocation
 - Remote team management
 - Freelance/contractual hiring
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Health and Safety at Work

Health and safety at work refers to the practices, policies, and regulations that ensure a safe and healthy working environment for employees.

Importance:

- Prevents workplace injuries and illnesses.
- Increases employee morale and productivity.
- Reduces medical leaves and legal liabilities.
- Essential for IT workers who spend long hours on computers (mental health, posture, vision care).

Key Aspects in IT Context:

- **Ergonomics:** Proper chairs, screens, and desk arrangements.
- **Mental Health:** Managing burnout, stress from deadlines.
- **Fire and Electrical Safety:** Especially in server rooms and data centers.
- **Cyber Safety:** Protecting employees from online threats (phishing, data leaks).
- **Health Policies:** Regular breaks, eye care tips, vaccination drives, insurance coverage.

Laws and Guidelines (general/global):

- **Occupational Safety and Health Administration (OSHA)**
- **Factories Act (Pakistan)**
- **Health and Safety at Work Act (UK)**

Summary of Importance for All Topics:

Topic	Importance
Employee Relations Law	Legal clarity, protection, and smooth operations
Changing Management Practices	Adaptability and competitiveness in modern organizations
HRM and IT	Managing technical teams effectively and ethically
Health and Safety	Ensures physical and mental well-being of employees

